

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 25, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 125

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 46448.27 ▲ 202.86 0.44% NASDAQ 22872.01 ▲ 2.7% STOXX 600 562.88 ▲ 0.1% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 7/32, yield 4.035% OIL \$58.84 ▲ \$0.78 GOLD \$4,091.90 ▲ \$15.20 EURO \$1.1522 YEN 156.92

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **San Francisco Fed** President Mary Daly said she supports cutting interest rates at the central bank's meeting next month, balancing the odds of a job market slump against a potential spike in inflation. **A2**
- ◆ **The Fed is struggling** to persuade some banks to use a lending tool designed to improve the central bank's control over short-term money markets. **A2**
- ◆ **Chip stocks** and other big tech shares rallied, powering robust gains in major U.S. indexes. The S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow rose 1.5%, 2.7% and 0.4%, respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **Shares of Bayer** rose after the company reported positive results for an experimental stroke-preventing drug which had been shown to be ineffective in another trial. **B2**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** said it would settle its lawsuit against RealPage, which it had accused of enabling landlords to illegally coordinate rental-price increases. **B3**
- ◆ **Kohl's confirmed** as chief executive Michael Bender, who had been serving in the role in an interim capacity. **B1**
- ◆ **Boeing's troubled** Starliner spacecraft is scheduled to fly again in April on an uncrewed mission. **B3**
- ◆ **Amazon.com** said it would invest \$50 billion to expand AI and high-performance computing capabilities for U.S. government users of its cloud services. **B4**
- ◆ **Harbour Energy** is exploring offshore and onshore bids and deals in the U.S. as its production base shifts toward the western Atlantic. **B4**

World-Wide

- ◆ **A judge dismissed** criminal charges against former FBI Director James Comey and New York Attorney General Letitia James, ruling that the prosecutor Trump chose to bring the cases was unlawfully appointed. **A1**
- ◆ **U.S. and Ukrainian** diplomats thrashing out changes to a Trump-backed plan for ending the war have left thorny decisions over territory to their countries' presidents. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump's advisers** are discussing a proposal to head off sharp increases in health-insurance costs for millions of Americans next year, the explosive issue at the heart of the recent government shutdown. **A3**
- ◆ **The Pentagon said it** is probing allegations of misconduct against Sen. Mark Kelly after he appeared in a video urging troops to disobey unlawful orders. **A4**
- ◆ **Portland Trail Blazers** coach Chauncey Billups pleaded not guilty to charges that he profited from rigged poker games involving Mafia figures and at least one ex-NBA player. **A5**
- ◆ **Japanese Prime Minister** Sanae Takaichi, who has emerged as an irritant to China by her comments on regional affairs, is enjoying buoyant approval ratings at home. **A7**
- ◆ **Colombia's military** said it opened an investigation into allegations that senior army and intelligence officials had advised the leader of an armed drug-trafficking group. **A8**
- ◆ **Died: Viola Ford Fletcher**, 111, Tulsa Race Massacre survivor. **A5** ... **Jimmy Cliff**, 81, reggae legend. **A8**

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Comey, James Cases Are Tossed

Federal judge finds a Trump-aligned prosecutor wasn't lawfully appointed

By C. RYAN BARBER

A federal judge dismissed criminal charges on Monday against both former FBI Director James Comey and New York Attorney General Letitia James, ruling that the prosecutor President Trump chose

to bring the cases was unlawfully appointed.

The pair of decisions from Judge Cameron McGowan Currie deal a setback to the Justice Department in two high-profile criminal cases it brought after Trump publicly called on Attorney General Pam Bondi to prosecute several of his prominent critics, including Comey and James.

Comey and James both contested Lindsey Halligan's appointment as the interim U.S. attorney in eastern Vir-

ginia, while also pointing to Trump's public statements to argue that his prosecution was rooted in the president's desire for retribution against perceived adversaries.

Currie, an appointee of former President Bill Clinton who normally sits in South Carolina, agreed with arguments from Comey and James that the Trump administration had unlawfully bypassed the customary confirmation process by installing Halligan.

Currie also rejected Bondi's

ratification of the two indictments—weeks after they were filed—in a bid to bolster them against challenges to Halligan's appointment.

"The implications of a contrary conclusion are extraordinary," the judge wrote. "It would mean the Government could send any private citizen off the street—attorney or not—into the grand jury room to secure an indictment so long as the Attorney General gives her approval after the fact."

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U.S. and Ukraine Run Into Sticking Points

Envoys to put off crucial territorial issue for Trump, Zelensky to decide

U.S. and Ukrainian diplomats thrashing out changes to a Trump-backed peace plan have left thorny decisions over territory to their countries' presidents, European officials familiar with the discussions said.

By Laurence Norman,
Robbie Gramer
and Benoit Faucon

Officials from Washington left the Geneva meeting over the weekend expressing optimism about the modifications during what they called "constructive talks."

But significant sticking points remain, in particular what happens to territory coveted by the Kremlin in eastern Ukraine that Russia hasn't been able to capture in nearly four years of attritional warfare.

Kyiv said surrendering the rest of the Donbas region that it still holds, including heavily fortified strategic cities, would leave Ukraine vulnerable to future assaults by Moscow.

Negotiators found common ground on some matters at issue in the U.S. plan to end the war and reduced the points in the proposed deal down to 19 from the initial 28, according to European diplomats.

The newly edited plan proposed a cap on the size of Ukraine's military at 800,000 troops instead of 600,000 that was originally envisioned, according to two of the people briefed on the contents of the plan. The new proposal also softened language on blocking future expansion of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization, those people said.

Some of the officials who were briefed on the talks said that questions over territory would now be dealt with at the presidential level.

The White House declined to comment on the revised plan. President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said he would discuss the plan with President Trump.

INSIDE



JASON GAY

What's eating the Eagles? Struggling Super Bowl champs are in a 'funk.' **A16**

BUSINESS & FINANCE

Novo Nordisk shares slump after Ozempic pill fails in Alzheimer's trials. **B1**

Next Stop on the Gravy Train: The White House



PARDON US: This year's National Thanksgiving Turkeys, Waddle and Gobble, enjoy a taste of the high life Monday at the Willard InterContinental hotel in Washington a day before they receive the traditional presidential pardon at the White House.

Robots Remake Chinese Industry

Factories learn to turn out more goods faster, cheaper and with fewer workers

By BRIAN SPEGELE

Sam Altman wants artificial intelligence to cure cancer. Elon Musk says AI robots will eliminate poverty.

China is focused on something more prosaic: making better washing machines.

While China's long-term AI goals are no less ambitious than the U.S. tech titans, its near-term priority is to shore up its role as the world's factory floor for decades to come. With exports un-

der threat from rising costs at home and tariffs abroad, that is no longer assured.

The push can be seen across the giant country in scores of companies—fueled by billions of dollars in government and private technology development—that are transforming every step of making and exporting goods.

A clothing designer reports slashing the time it takes to make a sample by more than 70% with AI. Washing machines in China's hinterland are being

churned out under the command of an AI "factory brain."

At one of China's biggest ports, shipping containers whiz about on self-driving trucks with virtually no workers in sight, while the port's scheduling is run by AI.

Executives involved in China's efforts liken the future of factories to living organisms that can increasingly think and adapt.

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◆ 'Sovereign AI' takes off..... **A9**

Economy Is Now Addicted to AI Spending

By KONRAD PUTZIER

The turbulence that hit stocks tied to artificial intelligence last week highlights a broader risk to the economy. Growth has become so dependent on AI-related investment and wealth that if the boom turns to bust, it could take the broader economy with it.

Business investment in AI might have accounted for as much as half of the growth in gross domestic product, adjusted for inflation, in the first six months of the year. Rising AI stocks are also boosting household wealth, leading to more consumer spending, especially in recent months.

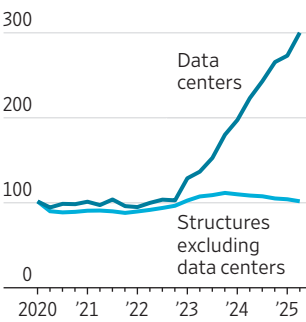
◆ **Chip stocks, Alphabet** propel rebound..... **B1**

"It's certainly plausible that the economy would already be in a recession" without the AI boom, said Peter Berezin, chief global strategist at BCA Research.

Take away AI spending, and the economy looks in worse shape. Although job growth was higher than expected in September, job creation has nonetheless slowed this year and the unemployment rate is inching up. Private business investment excluding AI-related categories is mostly flat since 2019, according to Deutsche Bank. Outside of data centers, other commercial construction, such as shopping centers or office buildings, is down.

That makes the economy more dependent on AI. "It's the only source of investment

Real private nonresidential fixed investment, quarterly



Note: Index measures the change in the seasonally adjusted annual rate; chained 2017 dollars. 1Q 2020=100.
Source: BofA Global Research

right now," said Stephen Juneau, an economist at Bank of America.

Bank of America estimated

that just four companies—Microsoft, Amazon.com, Alphabet and Meta Platforms—will make \$344 billion in capital expenditures this year (equivalent to about 1.1% of GDP), up from \$228 billion last year.

Barclays estimated that investment in software, computer equipment and data centers boosted GDP growth by around 1 percentage point annualized in the first half of 2025. AI explained much, though not all, of that.

Chips such as those sold by Nvidia make up the bulk of AI spending, but most are imported and must be subtracted from total investment to arrive at the impact on domestic production. Accounting for that, AI spending still in-

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Restaurant Chefs Go to Extremes To Master the Turkey Dinner

Adapting the dry, ungainly bird to other countries' cuisines is 'a lot of trial and error'

By CHARLES PASSY

For generations, Americans have marked Thanksgiving by wrestling with the perfect way to prepare and serve turkey, a bird known for its ungainly size, dry texture and lack of distinguishing flavor.

Now, chefs of various cultural backgrounds are trying

to get in on the action by crafting turkey dishes that speak to their roots. Restaurant diners at this time of year can find Peking turkey, jerk turkey, tandoori turkey and even the French take. (It's complicated.) A Mexican spot serves turkey *al pastor*.

But adapting the high-

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Four Apple Insiders Top Successor List, Though Cook Shows No Sign of Exiting

By ROLFE WINKLER

Tim Cook shows no signs of slowing down. Famous for rising before the sun to answer emails and work out, he has devoted much of his life to Apple and has said he wants to stay at the company for some time.

Yet since Cook recently turned 65 years old, an age when other executives are often headed into retirement, analysts, investors and Apple

watchers have been abuzz with chatter: Who is next in line to run perhaps the most iconic American company?

To be clear, Cook doesn't need to leave—Apple has no mandatory retirement age for executives—and there seems no pressure on him to do so. Notwithstanding the company's recent stumbles in artificial intelligence, he has delivered spectacularly for shareholders, driving up Apple's market capitalization by

more than an order of magnitude since he took over the top job in 2011.

Apple's longtime Chairman Art Levinson is 75, the age after which Apple board members generally step down. Cook, already an Apple director, could level up to chairman and make room for a new chief executive or take on both titles for a time like many of his S&P 500 peers.

The top potential successor is likely to be Tim Cook.

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